



EXPECTATIONS CHECKLIST

THREE THINGS EVERY CLEAR EXPECTATION NEEDS

THE WHAT:

What specific outcome are you asking for?

Name the result, not the activity. "A reconciled report with variances flagged," not "work on the reconciliation."

Write yours:

THE WHEN:

By when, exactly?

A real date or a real timeframe. If the work is ongoing rather than a one-time deliverable, define the response time instead: "within four business hours," not "promptly."

Write yours:

THE WHAT-IF:

How do they tell you something's gone sideways?

This is the one most managers skip, and it's the one that prevents surprises. Name the trigger and the timing: "If the date is going to be tight, tell me by the first business day."

Write yours:

What is sounds like put together:

"The report's due the third business day after month-end. I'll send you last month's version as a model for the format. And if anything's ever going to make that date tight, tell me by the first business day so we can adjust."

Thirty seconds. Three parts. No guessing.